

Format-as-analogy-generator

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The observation that a file format is not just storage — it seeds analogies and behaviors. The per-memo-file layout (one memo per file, vs a single ledger) seeded unexpected parallel-PR patterns: two sessions could each issue a memo without a merge conflict, which made parallel fan-outs structurally cheaper than they would have been with a shared ledger.

Where named

MEMO-2026-05-06-3vvg. Builds on the per-memo migration in issue #210.

Related

- Memo
- Peer-instance symmetry
- The eight afternoons
- Substrate

Detail

When the memo corpus was a single `memo_index.md` ledger, two parallel sessions issuing memos would race on edits to the same file. Resolving the race meant either serializing memo issuance (losing parallelism) or post-hoc merging (losing the simple “one PR per memo” workflow). After issue #210 split the ledger into one file per memo, parallel issuance became free.

The “analogy generator” framing is that the format change wasn’t just operational. It made parallel fan-outs *expectable*. Once two instances could issue memos without colliding, the chain found reasons to actually run two instances in parallel — the eight afternoons (accidental) and the laughing-davinci dispatch (deliberate). The format had implicitly licensed a behavior the chain went on to do.